



The Norton Internet Security Interface

improves the ability of NIS to block spyware, ad-ware, key-loggers, and other malware during installation. The Security Inspector finds, and in some cases patches, potential security holes, including weak browser settings and Windows passwords. For example, our test bed's Windows XP was not password-protected. Security Inspector detected this and suggested that we set a password of at least eight characters with at least one numeric character.

The Norton Home Page Hijacking Protection feature prevents rogue applications from changing your browser's home page to their own. Then there is Norton Firewall which is intelligent enough to form rules about which programs it should allow Internet access to, without needing the user's intervention.

Like its predecessors, the program also features a heuristic scan, or Bloodhound as Symantec calls it. A heuristic scan allows the program to detect an unknown virus, just from its suspicious activities. It works on the principle that viruses usually use documented tricks or methods of infecting, and if a file is found to